

CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY

The Practical Handbook Series

Email Marketing

Build a list and turn subscribers into loyal customers.

You will learn to grow an email list, choose the right tools, write emails people open and act on, automate sequences, personalise at scale, and improve with data.

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Email Marketing

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A note before you begin

Email marketing quietly outperforms almost every other channel on return for money spent. Why? Because an email list is an audience you own outright - not rented from a social platform that can change its rules or bury your posts tomorrow.

For any business, freelancer or creator, learning email marketing means learning to build and profit from a direct relationship with people who chose to hear from you. It is a skill you can sell and one that pays a business back for years.

Apply each chapter to a real or imagined business. The exercises build, step by step, into a complete email strategy you can actually run.

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Introduction to email marketing

Email marketing is using email to build relationships and drive sales - sending valuable, relevant messages to people who've given you permission to contact them. Unlike social media, you're not fighting an algorithm or renting attention; you reach subscribers directly. That ownership and directness are why email returns so much for every shilling spent.

The mindset that matters: email is about relationship, not spam. You earn the right to sell by consistently providing value and respecting the reader. Done well, your emails are welcomed, opened and acted on. Done badly (constant selling, irrelevant blasts), people unsubscribe. Treat your list as a privilege, and it becomes a powerful, lasting asset.

IN PRACTICE

A creator with a modest email list of a few hundred true fans launched a product and made more sales than a rival with tens of thousands of passive social followers - because email reached people directly and personally, and they trusted her.

TRY THIS

Write down why email marketing suits a business you know, and what value you could send its customers that they'd actually want.

Key takeaways

- Email reaches an audience you own directly.
- It's about relationship, not spam.
- A respected list is a lasting asset.

Building your email list

You can't do email marketing without subscribers, and people won't hand over their email for nothing. You need a 'lead magnet' - something valuable offered in exchange for signing up: a discount, a useful guide, a checklist, a free resource. The better and more relevant the offer, the faster your list grows with the right people.

Place sign-up opportunities where your audience is - on your website, social profiles, at checkout, in your content. Always get genuine permission (never buy or scrape lists - it's ineffective and often illegal). Focus on quality over sheer size: a smaller list of genuinely interested people is far more valuable than a huge list of the indifferent.

IN PRACTICE

An online tutor offered a free 'exam preparation checklist' in exchange for an email. Students happily signed up, and she then nurtured them toward her paid classes. The free, relevant lead magnet built a list of exactly the right people.

TRY THIS

Design a lead magnet for your chosen business: what valuable free thing would its ideal customer gladly give their email for? Write its title.

Key takeaways

- Offer a valuable lead magnet to earn sign-ups.
- Put sign-up options where your audience is.
- Quality of subscribers beats raw quantity.

Choosing an email platform

You need an email marketing tool (like Mailchimp, MailerLite, and others) to manage subscribers, send bulk emails legally and professionally, and automate sequences - never use your personal Gmail for this. Most have free tiers generous enough for beginners, so cost is not a barrier to starting properly.

Choose based on ease of use and the features you'll actually need: list management, templates, automation, and analytics. Don't overthink it - pick a beginner-friendly platform, learn it well, and switch later only if you outgrow it. The tool matters less than how you use it; a simple platform used skilfully beats a powerful one used poorly.

IN PRACTICE

A small business owner started with a free MailerLite account, imported her sign-ups, and sent her first professional newsletter with a ready template in an afternoon. The free tool did everything she needed to begin earning from email.

TRY THIS

Create a free account on a beginner-friendly email platform. Explore how to add a subscriber, use a template, and send a test email to yourself.

Key takeaways

- Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.
- Free tiers are enough to start.
- Ease of use matters more than fancy features.

Writing compelling emails

A great marketing email has three jobs: get opened, get read, and get action. The subject line earns the open (make it intriguing or clearly valuable, never clickbait that disappoints). The body earns attention with a friendly, personal tone and one clear message. And a single, obvious call to action tells the reader exactly what to do next.

Write like a human talking to one person, not a corporation broadcasting. Keep it focused - resist cramming multiple offers into one email. Provide value or interest, not just constant selling, so people keep opening your future emails. Consistency of a welcome, valuable voice is what turns a list into loyal customers.

IN PRACTICE

A shop's emails were ignored until they switched from formal 'Dear valued customer' blasts to warm, personal notes with one clear offer and a friendly tone. Opens and sales rose - people respond to a human, not a megaphone.

TRY THIS

Write one complete marketing email: an intriguing subject line, a warm personal opening, one clear message, and one call to action.

Key takeaways

- Subject line gets the open; body gets the read.
- One email, one message, one action.
- Sound human; mix value with offers.

Automating email sequences

Automation is email marketing's superpower: you set up sequences once, and they run automatically for every new subscriber. The most important is a 'welcome sequence' - a series of emails that greets new subscribers, delivers value, tells your story, and gently leads them toward a purchase, all without you lifting a finger after setup.

Automations can also handle things like abandoned carts, post-purchase follow-ups, and re-engaging inactive subscribers. This means the right message reaches the right person at the right time, at scale, while you sleep. Setting up smart automations is what makes email marketing efficient and, frankly, close to passive income for a business.

IN PRACTICE

An online store set up a 3-email welcome sequence: a warm hello, a helpful tip, then a first-purchase discount. Every new subscriber now gets nurtured automatically, and a steady share buy - all running on autopilot after one setup.

TRY THIS

Outline a 3-email welcome sequence for your business: email 1 (welcome + value), email 2 (build trust/story), email 3 (a clear offer).

Key takeaways

- Set up sequences once; they run automatically.
- A welcome sequence nurtures every new subscriber.
- Automation delivers the right message at scale.

Segmentation and personalisation

Not all subscribers are the same, and treating them identically wastes the power of email. Segmentation means grouping your list (by interest, behaviour, purchase history, or location) so you can send more relevant messages to each group. A relevant email to the right segment vastly outperforms a generic blast to everyone.

Personalisation goes further - using the subscriber's name, referencing their past actions, and tailoring content to feel one-to-one. Modern platforms make this easy. The more relevant and personal your emails feel, the more they're opened, trusted and acted on. People engage with messages that feel like they were written for them, because effectively they were.

IN PRACTICE

A store sent past buyers of running shoes a targeted email about new running gear, while sending beginners a 'getting started' guide. Both segments responded far better than a single generic email would - relevance drove the results.

TRY THIS

For your business, define two or three subscriber segments and one tailored message you'd send to each.

Key takeaways

- Segment your list to stay relevant.
- Personalise with names and past behaviour.
- Relevant, personal emails vastly outperform blasts.

Analytics and optimisation

Email is highly measurable, so improvement is straightforward if you watch the right numbers. Key metrics: open rate (are subject lines working?), click rate (is the content and call to action compelling?), and conversions (are people actually buying or acting?). Also watch unsubscribes - a spike means you're sending too much or the wrong things.

Use these numbers to improve continuously. Test different subject lines, send times, and content, and keep what performs (this is called A/B testing). Small, steady optimisations compound into big gains over time. The marketer who reads the data and adjusts will always outperform the one who just keeps sending the same emails and hoping.

IN PRACTICE

A newsletter's opens were low until the sender tested shorter, curiosity-driven subject lines. One style clearly won, opens climbed, and every future email benefited - a simple test, found by watching the data, that paid off repeatedly.

TRY THIS

List the three email metrics you'll track and write one simple A/B test you'd run (e.g. two subject lines) to improve results.

Key takeaways

- Track opens, clicks, conversions and unsubscribes.
- A/B test and keep what works.
- Small optimisations compound over time.

Run a full email campaign

Your final project ties it all together: plan a complete email campaign for a real or imagined business. Define the goal (e.g. launch a product, drive sales), your lead magnet and how you'll grow the list, your welcome sequence, and the campaign emails themselves, plus how you'll measure success. A campaign is a coordinated set of emails driving toward one objective.

Then, ideally, run it for real - even a small version. Build the list, send the sequence, watch the numbers, and learn. This hands-on experience turns email marketing from theory into a demonstrable skill you can sell to businesses or use to grow your own. Email rewards the consistent: keep nurturing your list and it keeps paying back.

IN PRACTICE

A learner ran a small campaign for a friend's bakery: a free-recipe lead magnet grew a list, a welcome sequence built trust, and a launch email for a new product drove real weekend orders - a full campaign, real results, a proven skill.

TRY THIS

Plan a full email campaign on one page: goal, lead magnet, welcome sequence, campaign emails, and metrics. Run a small version if you can.

Key takeaways

- A campaign coordinates emails toward one goal.
- Plan list-building, sequence, emails and metrics.
- Consistent nurturing keeps a list paying back.

KEEP GOING

Skills pay for life. Now go use them.

Finishing the reading is not the goal - finishing the project is. Pick the one exercise in this book that scared you most and do it this week. Then bring your work to your CHRISCO facilitator or post it online. That single habit - shipping real work - is what separates the youth who earn from the youth who only dream.

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